

Task 1: Academic Research

i)

- Google Scholar
- JSTOR
- The Chinese Historical Review

ii)

- Teiser, S. F., & Verellen, F. (2011). Buddhism, Daoism, and Chinese Religion. *Cahiers d'Extrême-Asie*, 20, 1–12. <https://n9.cl/3rqs5>
- McLeod, A. (2015). Philosophy in Eastern Han Dynasty China (25–220 CE): Eastern Han Philosophy. *Philosophy Compass*, 10(6), 355–368.
- Pan, M. (2004). Confucianism and the Chinese Legal Tradition: Recent Scholarships on Chinese Legal History and Jurisprudence Studies. *The Chinese Historical Review*, 11(2), 225–236. <https://doi.org/10.1080/1547402X.2004.11827205>

Regarding JSTOR, I was able to find much better information that I think is a little more interesting, and I found it much easier to use than other sites. The only thing I didn't like is that I have to pay because my searches are limited.

I really like Google Scholar because I found the information very easily, and I can also download the PDFs.

As for the other sources, I didn't like them as much because I feel that my search process is more difficult.

Task 2: Presentation Zen

1. Do you typically use PowerPoint (or a similar software) when you are asked to give a presentation? Do you like giving presentations before groups of people?

Yes, I currently use the Canva app, it's so easy to use and it gives me a lot of tools, templates, and all various formats. Besides, I like to be in front of people, although I think that depends on the topic and the audience, I'm an extrovert, so I can manage my nerves, but I have to admit that sometimes it causes me some stress, so with time and especially practice, I can enhance my communication skills, and a time will come when it won't cause me any problem.

2. What questions should you be asking about presentation design and delivery that you have not asked in the past?
 - Do I want my presentation to make an impact?
 - What type of information it is really important for the audience? What is my core point?

- What is my purpose with this presentation?
 - What type of words can I use to captivate the audience?
 - What kind of images allude more the topic?
 - Why does it matter?
 - Who is the audience?
 - What is their background?
 - What do they expect of me?
 - What do I want them to do?
 - What visual medium is most appropriate for this particular situation and audience? What is the fundamental purpose of my talk?
 - What's the story here?
3. Do you think that, in the past, you have adhered to the suggested guidelines for Dynamic storytelling in presentations?

Some that I was taught a long time ago, but I can surely improve them today.

4. What aspects of the design and delivery process may have caused “suffering” for your audiences in the past?

In most cases, the text appears too small or too much text on the slides, the images are unclear or blurry, the speaker talks too softly, the presentation is too long, and one loses interest completely.

Task 3: The Joy Luck Club by Amy Tang

The novel *The Joy Luck Club* begins with a parable symbolizing the sacrifices and hopes of Chinese immigrant mothers and their Chinese-American daughters, who grow up with different customs, without understanding the great sacrifice made by their mothers. A woman travels to the United States with a swan that represents her dreams of a better future for her daughter, but upon arrival, she is left with only a feather after the swan is taken away. That feather practically represented the promise of passing on a meaningful legacy to her daughter, even though there is a cultural and linguistic gap between them.

This beginning leads into the story of Jing-Mei “June” Woo, who, after her mother's death, takes her place in the Joy Luck Club, a place created for women who had experienced tragedy and who could transform their sadness into small moments of joy through food, games, and stories. On that day her mother died, in addition to a painful sadness, her mother left her a great hidden secret: her mother had left behind twin daughters during the war in China, and now it is up to her to travel to Shanghai to reunite the family and fulfill her mother's last wish.

At the same time, it is revealed the childhood story of An-Mei Hsu, another member of the club, who grew up marked by the absence of her mother, considered a disgrace after becoming a concubine. However, on her grandmother's deathbed, An-Mei witnesses her mother's extreme sacrifice, who cuts a piece of flesh from her own body to prepare a medicinal soup as a great act of love. Although the grandmother dies, this gesture teaches An-Mei that physical pain is nothing compared to the strength and memory that are carried “in the bones.”

Together, the feather, the great hidden secret, and the scar function as symbols of the same message: the transmission of a maternal legacy that, although marked by pain, is also full of hope, resilience, and love. These first chapters of the novel underscore the central theme: the complex relationships between mothers and daughters, marked by cultural clashes and emotional inheritance, where each personal story is a way of learning to understand and recognize each other.

Translation

La novela *The Joy Luck Club* inicia con una parábola que simboliza los sacrificios y esperanzas de las madres inmigrantes chinas y sus hijas estadounidenses chinas, que crecen con costumbres distintas, sin comprender el gran sacrificio de las madres. Una mujer viaja a Estados Unidos con un cisne que representa sus sueños de un futuro mejor para su hija, pero al llegar solo le queda una pluma ya que le quitan al ave. Esa pluma prácticamente representaba la promesa de transmitirle a su hija un legado lleno de significado, aunque entre ambas exista un abismo cultural y lingüístico.

Este inicio abre paso a la historia de Jing-Mei “June” Woo, quien tras la muerte de su madre ocupa su lugar en el Joy Luck Club, un lugar creado para mujeres que habían vivido tragedias y que pudieran transformar la tristeza en pequeños momentos de alegría mediante la comida, el juego y las historias. El día que falleció su madre además de una dolorosa tristeza le dejó su madre un gran secreto, su madre había dejado atrás a dos hijas gemelas durante la guerra en China, y ahora le corresponde a ella viajar a Shanghái para reunir a la familia y cumplir el último deseo materno.

Al mismo tiempo, se revela la historia de la infancia de An-Mei Hsu, otra integrante del club, quien creció marcada por la ausencia de su madre, considerada una deshonra tras convertirse en concubina. Sin embargo, en el lecho de muerte de la abuela, An-Mei presencia el sacrificio extremo de su madre, quien se corta un pedazo de carne de su propio cuerpo para preparar una sopa medicinal como un gran acto de amor. Aunque la abuela muere, este gesto enseña a An-Mei que el dolor físico no es nada frente a la fortaleza y la memoria que se llevan “en los huesos”.

En conjunto, la pluma, el gran secreto oculto y la cicatriz funcionan como símbolos de un mismo mensaje: la transmisión de un legado materno que, aunque marcado por el dolor, también está lleno de esperanza, resiliencia y amor. Estos primeros pasajes de la novela subrayan el tema central: las complejas relaciones entre madres e hijas, atravesadas por el choque cultural y la herencia emocional, donde cada historia personal es una forma de aprender a comprenderse y reconocerse mutuamente.